

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

A collection of playing cards. In the background, four cards are displayed vertically: Queen of Spades, Queen of Hearts, King of Clubs, and 9 of Diamonds. In the foreground, a fan of cards is shown, including the King of Spades, 10 of Spades, 9 of Spades, 8 of Spades, Ace of Hearts, King of Hearts, 7 of Hearts, 6 of Hearts, 4 of Hearts, Ace of Clubs, 9 of Clubs, 6 of Clubs, and 4 of Diamonds.

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 6 2
♥ 10 9 7 2
♦ A K 10
♣ Q J 7

♠ K J 9 3

♥ Q 8 3

♦ 8 3

♣ A K 6 4



♠ A 4

♥ J 5

♦ Q J 6 5 2

♣ 10 9 8 5

♠ 10 8 7 5

♥ A K 6 4

♦ 9 7 4

♣ 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♦

Dbl

Pass

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

You have the special hand, 4-4 in the Majors, so you make a Negative Double. Partner replies 1 ♠.

Partner has a minimum opener with 4 ♠s. You have a minimum response with 4 ♠s. Pass and be grateful the opponents aren't bidding.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 7 3
♥ Q J
♦ 9 6 5
♣ K Q 8 4

♠ 5 4 2

♥ 8 3 2

♦ 10 3 2

♣ J 10 5 3



♠ K 10 9 8

♥ A K 7 6 4

♦ 4

♣ A 9 6

♠ A 6

♥ 10 9 5

♦ A K Q J 8 7

♣ 7 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Sometimes using Negative Doubles seems like you can read minds. You know for sure that partner has 4 ♠s since that is the only unbid Major. You know for sure that partner has 10+ points because he made a Negative Double of a 2-level overcall. So you conclude that your side has 8 ♠s and 27+ points and you bid 4 ♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

2 ♦

Dbl

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East